

games. "I'm not into blood and gore filled FPS games. Give me a simulation game any day," says Anindo. It is strategy over shoot-'em-ups, and the stack of games lying near his computer tells the story, most notably *The Sims 2*, with all expansion packs!

We noticed that all the software and games lying about were originals, and asked Anindo about piracy. "Perhaps your readers might be a little surprised to know that I buy all my software, but that's just how I like it," says Anindo. Perhaps more Indians need to work for a software technology and services company, in order to better understand how and why piracy is evil.

"You don't buy any FPS games?" we asked. "I just bought *Quake 4*, but all that blood and gore is not for me, so I promptly gave it to my brother," says Anindo, and goes on to describe the gore in *Quake 4* with a nauseated expression. Oh well, you can't win them all!

Apart from being a noted photographer, Anindo has been involved in technology consultancy and writing for several years. He has been a consultant for over a decade in the field of network design and implementation, and was the brains behind India's first ever cyber café and Web telecast a decade ago. His technology addiction forces him to buy games and gadgets by the dozen, and is something his friends and better half have given up trying to explain.

His Machine

Eager to get a peek inside his machine, which has a glass face and some funky UV laser lights that gave his room an eerie blue tinge, we final-



A WorldSpace Radio with a data connection also lets you use the data port for upto 128 Kbps of receiving incoming PC data

ly popped open the cabinet and Anindo gave us his now (in)famous "two dollar tour"!

The first thing you notice is the lighting, which is tastefully placed and not too in-your-face. Looking past the lights, we caught our first glimpse of something unique—a very strange-looking heat sink and cooling solution. "That's an Asetek VapoChill Micro Extreme CPU cooling solution that I got from the UK," says Anindo, reading the questions forming in our minds.

Asetek is a leading company in vapour and liquid cooling solutions in the UK, you can visit their site, www.asetek.com, for more information and products available.



A nifty portable media player—Anindo's Archos AV300 Mobile DV recorder

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Anindo loves his VapoChill cooling system and says it's helped him keep CPU temperatures lower by almost 20 degrees, especially when he's overclocking.

Overclocking? The word brings excitement to us Digit guys, and we immediately demanded to know more. "What have you overclocked, and by how much?" we demanded.

"The motherboard I have, the ASUS P5WD2 Premium, is a dream to overclock with. I mounted a dual-core Intel Pentium Extreme Edition 840, 3 GHz CPU on the board and managed to overclock it to 3.9 GHz. It ran perfectly for over two hours before it blue-screened. After a lot of

trial and error, I discovered that 3.3 GHz was the ideal speed at which performance was improved and temperature could be controlled



The Epson PictureMate is Anindo's printer of choice!

easily," says Anindo. Not bad, we thought: a 10 per cent increase in clock speeds is an admirable feat indeed.

We noticed that there were two RAM strips, both covered with copper heat sinks. When we asked about that, Anindo said, "Those are 1 GB, 667 MHz Transcend sticks—I used to have four of them, totalling 4 GB, but I didn't notice any performance improvement. Instead, all I noticed was an increase in power usage and heat generation!"

Since we knew he had played *Quake 4*, we looked at his graphics card next. Though we could tell immediately that it was an ATi X-800, we were more interested in the weird-looking contraption that was slotted in place below it. Anindo told us it was a Cyclone dual-fan cooler that he had picked up for his overclocked graphics card.

"While overclocking the graphics card I noticed the temperatures soaring to 90 or 95 degrees Celsius, and the peak rated operating temperature is 110 to 120 degrees! I knew I needed separate cooling for the graphics card as well, so I bought this Cyclone cooler," says Anindo. The only problem he had with it was that it occupied two PCI slots.

He also has a heat sink-cooler combination with dual fans and temperature controlled cool-

The Garmin GPSmap 60c is a compact GPS device

